Sarah VanVelzer

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Education

University of Waterloo — Waterloo, ON
Honours Bachelor of Computer Science, Business & Computer Science Double Degree — *Sep. 2024 – June 2029*

Wilfrid Laurier University — Waterloo, ON
Honours Bachelor of Business Administration, Business & Computer Science Double Degree — *Sep. 2024 – June 2029*

Most Recent Term Average: 11.4/12.0
Relevant Coursework: Financial Management I: Capital markets, DCF modeling, CAPM (12.0/12.0); Intro to Financial Accounting (12.0/12.0); Managerial Accounting (12.0/12.0); Intro to Microeconomics (12.0/12.0)
Honours: Governor General's Academic Medal, Class Valedictorian (2024)

Experience

Junior Investment Banking Analyst (Incoming) — Jan. 2027 – Apr. 2027
NewPoint Capital Partners Inc. — *Toronto, ON*
- Selected to support financial modeling, valuation analyses, and pitch/CIM preparation for M&A and financing transactions ranging $10M–$250M across mid-market clients

Accounting Co-op, Financial Insights & Reporting — Jan. 2026 – Apr. 2026
BDO Canada LLP — *Strathroy, ON*
- Built financial statements from raw client data in CaseWare and Excel across corporate tax returns, compilations, and no-report engagements
- Completed engagements 3x faster than co-ops at larger BDO offices (3–4 days vs. two weeks), per mentor feedback, while partnering closely with one teammate to deliver the highest T1 filing volume in the region
- Resolved client information discrepancies through close attention to detail, communicating directly with clients to correct issues under tight, deadline-driven turnaround

Senior Lifeguard & Swim Instructor — June 2022 – Aug. 2025
City of St. Thomas — *St. Thomas, ON*
- Designed original swim curricula and skill-assessment frameworks for approximately 120 students per summer, adapting instruction to individual skill levels
- Independently launched and operated a private swim lesson business end-to-end without oversight or support, managing scheduling, curriculum design, and client communication for families across the community

Projects

Jayfound (Hack the North) | *Next.js, Supabase, Vercel* — Sep. 2026
- Solo-built a talent-discovery platform connecting overlooked students in Jinja, Uganda with recruiters through mentor-endorsed portfolios showcasing real, hands-on work
- Designed a weighted ranking system combining portfolio depth, puzzle-arcade performance, and mentor endorsements so recruiters can filter and surface talent beyond traditional credentials

[case]Hacks | *Financial Feasibility & Product Strategy Case Competition* — May 2026
- Designed a Scotiabank investment product integrating Scene+ rewards with iTRADE to lift adoption among 18–34-year-old depositors
- Modeled product economics and delivered a 10-minute pitch to a judging panel, defending assumptions on adoption, retention, and financial feasibility under direct Q&A

Zyra | *React Native, TypeScript, Expo* — June 2026 – Present
- Independently designed and built a mobile productivity app, powered by a custom multi-factor algorithm that weighs deadline proximity, user engagement, and task neglect to dynamically re-rank priorities

Leadership & Global Impact

International STEM Outreach Lead — Spring 2024
Just Cause Education Outreach — *Jinja, Uganda*
- Planned and ran logistics for the Ugandan Robotics League championship, coordinating schedules, materials, and venue setup for 400+ students and coaches nationwide
- Designed and delivered an activities day for 200+ primary school students in a rural community, overcoming language barriers to lead group programming

Director of Internal & External Affairs — Sep. 2025 – Present
Double Degree Club — *Waterloo, ON*
- Led end-to-end planning of club-wide events and coordinated external communications and partnerships as part of the executive team

Skills & Interests

Business & Finance: Excel (VLOOKUP, Pivot Tables, Macros), Word, PowerPoint, CaseWare, Securities Valuation (Bond & Equity), Ratio Analysis, Financial Statement Analysis, Portfolio Theory & CAPM, Forecasting
Programming: Python, Java, C/C++, R, SQL, TypeScript/React Native, Next.js, Supabase
Interests: Marathon running & triathlons (4x OFSAA athlete), clarinet & piano, women-in-business & entrepreneurship